Total number of Self Help Groups in Tamil Nadu	3,11,663
Total number of members in SHGs (Tamil Nadu)	35,76,693
Internal Savings	186814.79 LAKHS
Total no of Micro Enterprises	9754
Total Fund given to Micro Enterprises	40182 LAKHS

Source: http://www.nrlm.gov.in 2017

Self Help Groups in India

In December 2017 there were 45,67,090 SHGs in India. The total number of members in SHGs during the same period stood at 5,02,65,933 at all India level.

The five year plans of the government of India has given due recognition to the relevance of the Self-help group concept to implement developmental schemes at the grassroots level.

SHGs in Tamil Nadu

In Tamil Nadu, Tamil Nadu Corporation for Development of Women Limited (TNCDW) was established in the year 1983 with the prime objective of socio economic development and empowerment of rural women. The Government of Tamil Nadu spearheaded the Self Help Group concept in the country by forming SHGs in Dharmapuri district with the assistance of International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD) in September 1989. The success of the IFAD project paved way for the now popularly called "*Mahalir Thittam*" project, which was launched during 1997-98 with the State Government funding and was progressively extended to all the 30 districts. The SHG movement has now emerged as a powerful and vibrant movement illuminating the lives of many poor women in the state.

Key Terms

Manufacturing enterprises
Service enterprise
Micro enterprise
Small enterprise
Medium enterprise
Self Help Group

Project

1. Prepare a report on a Self Help Group functioning in your locality.
2. Visiting a Handicraft unit to understand the nature and scope of its business, and analyse the sources of finance for expansion and modernization of the unit.



For Own Thinking

1. Role of women as entrepreneurs
2. Income-tax exemption for Start-up initiatives



For Future Learning

1. World Association of Small & Medium enterprises (WASME)
2. Ministry of MSME and its functions.

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